Configuration	Steady-state cost ($/hr)	Cost after warmup ($)	Pod evictions	Eviction cost
W1 (200 nodes)				
full (reference)	50.18 [48.52, 51.91]	192.0 [185.8, 198.2]	1,973 [1,849, 2,087]	1,973 [1,849, 2,087]
no-potential	45.29 Δ −10% [−12, −7]*	158.8 Δ −17% [−19, −16]	1,159 Δ −41% [−46, −37]	1,159 Δ −41% [−46, −37]
no-eviction-budget	42.40 Δ −16% [−19, −12]*	140.0 Δ −27% [−29, −25]	2,036 Δ +3% [−3, 10]	2,036 Δ +3% [−3, 10]
no-annealing	45.72 Δ −9% [−12, −6]*	156.9 Δ −18% [−20, −16]	1,249 Δ −37% [−40, −33]	1,249 Δ −37% [−40, −33]
no-randomness	46.43 Δ −7% [−11, −4]*	153.8 Δ −20% [−22, −18]	1,021 Δ −48% [−51, −45]	1,021 Δ −48% [−51, −45]
W2 (200 nodes)				
full (reference)	39.52 [35.28, 44.28]	155.4 [147.8, 163.9]	1,448 [1,331, 1,550]	1,448 [1,331, 1,550]
no-potential	34.50 Δ −13% [−20, −5]	142.1 Δ −9% [−11, −6]	344 Δ −76% [−79, −73]	344 Δ −76% [−79, −73]
no-eviction-budget	27.40 Δ −31% [−37, −24]*	135.0 Δ −13% [−16, −10]	1,927 Δ +33% [17, 52]	1,927 Δ +33% [17, 52]
no-annealing	35.76 Δ −10% [−19, 1]	150.8 Δ −2.9% [−6.4, 0.4]	1,144 Δ −21% [−30, −11]	1,144 Δ −21% [−30, −11]
no-randomness	33.37 Δ −16% [−22, −9]*	139.1 Δ −10% [−13, −8]	385 Δ −73% [−78, −69]	385 Δ −73% [−78, −69]

Mean over valid runs per configuration (n = 10 seeds). Reference rows: 95% bootstrap CI of the mean. Variant rows: Δ is the mean paired difference vs full on shared seeds as % of full's mean (absolute when full's mean is 0), with its 95% bootstrap CI; * Holm-adjusted paired Wilcoxon p < 0.05 (steady-state cost only: the preregistered ablation family of 8 tests; the other metrics are descriptive).